

THE ULTIMATE

DevOps Cheat Sheet

Docker • Jenkins • Linux

DOCKER

JENKINS

LINUX

Quick-reference commands and syntax for everyday use — no fluff, just what you need.

LINUX CHEAT SHEET

1. File & Directory Navigation

Command	What it does
<code>pwd</code>	Print current working directory.
<code>ls -la</code>	List all files (incl. hidden) with details.
<code>cd /path/to/dir</code>	Change directory.
<code>cd ..</code>	Go up one directory level.
<code>cd ~</code>	Go to home directory.
<code>mkdir myfolder</code>	Create a new directory.
<code>mkdir -p a/b/c</code>	Create nested directories at once.
<code>rmdir myfolder</code>	Remove an empty directory.
<code>rm -rf myfolder</code>	Force-remove a directory and its contents (careful!).
<code>tree</code>	Show directory structure as a tree.

2. File Operations

Command	What it does
<code>touch file.txt</code>	Create an empty file / update timestamp.
<code>cp a.txt b.txt</code>	Copy a file.
<code>cp -r dir1 dir2</code>	Copy a directory recursively.
<code>mv a.txt b.txt</code>	Move or rename a file.
<code>rm file.txt</code>	Delete a file.
<code>cat file.txt</code>	Print file contents.
<code>less file.txt</code>	View file page-by-page (q to quit).
<code>head -n 10 file.txt</code>	Show first 10 lines.
<code>tail -n 10 file.txt</code>	Show last 10 lines.
<code>tail -f app.log</code>	Follow a log file live (real-time updates).
<code>find / -name '*.log'</code>	Search for files by name across the system.
<code>locate filename</code>	Fast file search using an index (needs updatedb).

3. Permissions & Ownership

Command	What it does
<code>chmod 755 file.sh</code>	Set permissions: owner rwx, group/others rx.
<code>chmod +x script.sh</code>	Make a file executable.
<code>chown user:group file</code>	Change file owner and group.
<code>chown -R user:group dir/</code>	Recursively change ownership.
<code>umask</code>	Show default permission mask for new files.

Permission digits: 4=read, 2=write, 1=execute (add them up). e.g. 7 = rwx, 6 = rw-, 5 = r-x.

4. Process Management

Command	What it does
<code>ps aux</code>	List all running processes.

<code>top</code>	Live view of processes/CPU/memory usage.
<code>htop</code>	Improved, colorful version of top (may need install).
<code>kill PID</code>	Terminate a process by ID (graceful).
<code>kill -9 PID</code>	Force-kill a process.
<code>killall processname</code>	Kill all processes matching a name.
<code>jobs</code>	List background jobs in current shell.
<code>bg / fg</code>	Resume a job in background / foreground.
<code>nohup cmd &</code>	Run a command immune to hangups, in background.

5. Networking

Command	What it does
<code>ifconfig / ip a</code>	Show network interfaces and IP addresses.
<code>ping google.com</code>	Test connectivity to a host.
<code>curl https://url</code>	Fetch a URL's content from command line.
<code>wget https://url/file</code>	Download a file from the web.
<code>netstat -tulnp</code>	Show listening ports and related processes.
<code>ss -tulnp</code>	Modern replacement for netstat.
<code>scp file user@host:/path</code>	Copy a file to a remote server over SSH.
<code>ssh user@host</code>	Connect to a remote machine via SSH.
<code>ssh -i key.pem user@host</code>	SSH using a specific private key.

6. Package Management

Command	What it does
<code>apt update && apt upgrade</code>	Update package list & upgrade installed packages (Debian/Ubuntu).
<code>apt install pkgname</code>	Install a package (Debian/Ubuntu).
<code>apt remove pkgname</code>	Remove a package.
<code>yum install pkgname</code>	Install a package (CentOS/RHEL).
<code>dnf install pkgname</code>	Install a package (Fedora/newer RHEL).
<code>snap install pkgname</code>	Install a snap package (universal Linux package).

LINUX CHEAT SHEET (contd.)

7. Text Processing (grep, sed, awk)

Command	What it does
grep 'error' file.log	Search for lines containing 'error'.
grep -i 'error' file.log	Case-insensitive search.
grep -r 'TODO' .	Recursively search all files in current dir.
grep -v 'debug' file.log	Show lines NOT containing 'debug'.
sed 's/old/new/g' file	Replace all 'old' with 'new' in file (prints to screen).
sed -i 's/old/new/g' file	Replace in-place (edits the actual file).
awk '{print \$1}' file	Print the first column of each line.
sort file.txt	Sort lines alphabetically.
sort -n file.txt	Sort lines numerically.
uniq file.txt	Remove adjacent duplicate lines.
wc -l file.txt	Count number of lines in a file.
cut -d',' -f1 file.csv	Extract 1st field from a comma-separated file.

8. Disk & System Info

Command	What it does
df -h	Show disk space usage (human-readable).
du -sh folder/	Show total size of a folder.
free -h	Show RAM/swap usage.
uname -a	Show kernel & system info.
uptime	Show how long the system has been running.
lscpu	Show CPU details.
history	Show command history.
whoami	Show current logged-in user.
date	Show current date and time.

9. Users & Groups

Command	What it does
adduser john	Create a new user (interactive).
passwd john	Set/change a user's password.
usermod -aG sudo john	Add user 'john' to the sudo group.
deluser john	Delete a user.
su - john	Switch to another user's session.
sudo command	Run a single command with admin (root) privileges.

10. Archives & Compression

Command	What it does
tar -cvf out.tar dir/	Create a tar archive from a directory.
tar -xvf out.tar	Extract a tar archive.

<code>tar -czvf out.tar.gz dir/</code>	Create a gzip-compressed tar archive.
<code>tar -xzvf out.tar.gz</code>	Extract a .tar.gz archive.
<code>zip -r out.zip dir/</code>	Create a zip archive.
<code>unzip out.zip</code>	Extract a zip archive.

11. I/O Redirection & Pipes

Command	What it does
<code>cmd > file.txt</code>	Redirect output to file (overwrite).
<code>cmd >> file.txt</code>	Redirect output to file (append).
<code>cmd 2> err.txt</code>	Redirect only error output to file.
<code>cmd1 cmd2</code>	Pipe output of cmd1 as input to cmd2.
<code>cmd < input.txt</code>	Use file contents as input to a command.

DOCKER CHEAT SHEET

1. Images

Command	What it does
<code>docker pull nginx</code>	Download an image from Docker Hub.
<code>docker images</code>	List all local images.
<code>docker build -t myapp:1.0 .</code>	Build an image from a Dockerfile in current dir.
<code>docker rmi myapp:1.0</code>	Remove an image.
<code>docker tag myapp:1.0 repo/myapp:1.0</code>	Tag an image for pushing to a registry.
<code>docker push repo/myapp:1.0</code>	Push an image to a registry (e.g. Docker Hub).
<code>docker history myapp:1.0</code>	Show the layers/history of an image.
<code>docker save -o myapp.tar myapp:1.0</code>	Export an image to a .tar file.
<code>docker load -i myapp.tar</code>	Import an image from a .tar file.

2. Containers

Command	What it does
<code>docker run nginx</code>	Run a container from an image.
<code>docker run -d -p 8080:80 nginx</code>	Run detached, mapping host port 8080 to container port 80.
<code>docker run -it ubuntu bash</code>	Run interactively with a terminal (bash shell).
<code>docker run --name web -d nginx</code>	Run a container with a custom name.
<code>docker ps</code>	List running containers.
<code>docker ps -a</code>	List all containers (including stopped).
<code>docker stop container_id</code>	Stop a running container.
<code>docker start container_id</code>	Start a stopped container.
<code>docker restart container_id</code>	Restart a container.
<code>docker rm container_id</code>	Remove a stopped container.
<code>docker rm -f container_id</code>	Force-remove a running container.
<code>docker logs container_id</code>	View a container's logs.
<code>docker logs -f container_id</code>	Follow container logs live.
<code>docker exec -it container_id bash</code>	Open a shell inside a running container.
<code>docker inspect container_id</code>	Show detailed JSON info about a container.
<code>docker stats</code>	Live stream of container resource usage.
<code>docker cp file.txt container_id:/app/</code>	Copy a file into a running container.

3. Dockerfile Instructions (Quick Reference)

Command	What it does
<code>FROM ubuntu:22.04</code>	Base image to build from.
<code>WORKDIR /app</code>	Set the working directory inside the container.
<code>COPY . .</code>	Copy files from host into the image.

ADD archive.tar.gz /app	Like COPY, but can also auto-extract archives / fetch URLs.
RUN apt-get install -y curl	Run a command at build time (creates a new layer).
ENV NODE_ENV=production	Set an environment variable.
EXPOSE 3000	Document which port the container listens on.
CMD ["node", "app.js"]	Default command run when container starts (overridable).
ENTRYPOINT ["python3"]	Fixed command that always runs (args appended to it).
VOLUME /data	Declare a mount point for persistent data.
ARG VERSION=1.0	Build-time variable (not available at runtime).

DOCKER CHEAT SHEET (contd.)

4. Volumes (Persistent Data)

Command	What it does
<code>docker volume create mydata</code>	Create a named volume.
<code>docker volume ls</code>	List all volumes.
<code>docker volume inspect mydata</code>	Show details about a volume.
<code>docker volume rm mydata</code>	Remove a volume.
<code>docker run -v mydata:/app/data nginx</code>	Mount a named volume into a container.
<code>docker run -v \$(pwd):/app nginx</code>	Mount current host directory (bind mount).

5. Networking

Command	What it does
<code>docker network ls</code>	List all Docker networks.
<code>docker network create mynet</code>	Create a custom network.
<code>docker network inspect mynet</code>	Show details about a network.
<code>docker run --network=mynet nginx</code>	Attach a container to a specific network.
<code>docker network connect mynet container_id</code>	Connect a running container to a network.

6. Docker Compose

Command	What it does
<code>docker compose up</code>	Start all services defined in docker-compose.yml.
<code>docker compose up -d</code>	Start services in detached (background) mode.
<code>docker compose down</code>	Stop and remove all services, networks.
<code>docker compose ps</code>	List running services in the compose project.
<code>docker compose logs -f</code>	Follow logs of all services.
<code>docker compose build</code>	Build/rebuild images defined in the compose file.
<code>docker compose exec web bash</code>	Open a shell inside the 'web' service container.

Example docker-compose.yml

```
version: '3.8'
services:
  web:
    build: .
    ports:
      - "8080:80"
    volumes:
      - ./app:/usr/share/nginx/html
    depends_on:
      - db
  db:
    image: mysql:8
    environment:
      MYSQL_ROOT_PASSWORD: secret
```



```
volumes:
  - db_data:/var/lib/mysql
volumes:
  db_data:
```

7. Cleanup Commands

Command	What it does
<code>docker system df</code>	Show disk space used by Docker (images/containers/volumes).
<code>docker container prune</code>	Remove all stopped containers.
<code>docker image prune</code>	Remove unused (dangling) images.
<code>docker image prune -a</code>	Remove ALL unused images (not just dangling).
<code>docker volume prune</code>	Remove all unused volumes.
<code>docker system prune -a --volumes</code>	Nuke everything unused: containers, images, networks, volumes.

JENKINS CHEAT SHEET

1. Declarative Pipeline Skeleton

```
pipeline {
  agent any
  environment {
    APP_ENV = 'production'
  }
  options {
    timeout(time: 30, unit: 'MINUTES')
  }
  stages {
    stage('Checkout') {
      steps { git 'https://github.com/example/app.git' }
    }
    stage('Build') {
      steps { sh 'mvn clean package' }
    }
    stage('Test') {
      steps { sh 'mvn test' }
    }
    stage('Deploy') {
      when { branch 'main' }
      steps { sh './deploy.sh' }
    }
  }
  post {
    success { echo 'Build succeeded!' }
    failure { echo 'Build failed.' }
    always { cleanWs() }
  }
}
```

2. Core Declarative Directives

Command	What it does
agent any / agent none / agent { label 'x' }	Where the pipeline (or stage) runs.
stages { stage('Name') { ... } }	Container for one or more named build stages.
steps { sh '...' }	The actual commands executed inside a stage.
environment { VAR = 'value' }	Define environment variables for the pipeline/stage.
parameters { string(name:'V', ...) }	Ask for user input before the build starts.
triggers { cron('H 2 * * *') }	Schedule automatic builds (cron-style).
when { branch 'main' }	Conditionally run a stage.
parallel { stage(...) stage(...) }	Run multiple stages simultaneously.
post { success{} failure{} always{} }	Actions to run after pipeline/stage completes.
options { timeout(...) retry(2) }	Pipeline-wide behavior settings.
tools { maven 'M3' jdk 'JDK17' }	Auto-install/use pre-configured build tools.

3. Common Pipeline Steps

Command	What it does
sh 'command'	Run a shell command (Linux/Mac agents).
bat 'command'	Run a Windows batch command.

echo 'message'	Print a message to the console log.
git url: '...', branch: 'main'	Checkout code from a Git repository.
checkout scm	Checkout using the SCM configured for the job.
junit 'reports/*.xml'	Publish JUnit test result reports.
archiveArtifacts 'build/*.jar'	Save build output files for later download.
input message: 'Deploy?'	Pause and wait for manual approval.
withCredentials([...]) { }	Safely inject secrets into a block of steps.
retry(3) { sh '...' }	Retry a step up to N times if it fails.
timeout(time: 5, unit: 'MINUTES') { }	Fail a block if it exceeds the given time.
cleanWs()	Clean the workspace directory.

JENKINS CHEAT SHEET (contd.)

4. Docker Agent Syntax

```
pipeline {
  agent {
    docker { image 'node:20-alpine' }
  }
  stages {
    stage('Test') {
      steps { sh 'npm install && npm test' }
    }
  }
}
```

5. Shared Library Usage

Command	What it does
@Library('my-lib') _	Import a global shared library at the top of a Jenkinsfile.
vars/myStep.groovy	File defining a reusable global function (e.g. myStep()).
myStep('arg1')	Call a shared library function inside any pipeline.

6. Useful Built-in Environment Variables

Command	What it does
env.BUILD_NUMBER	Current build's number.
env.JOB_NAME	Name of the current job/pipeline.
env.WORKSPACE	Path where code was checked out.
env.BRANCH_NAME	Current Git branch (multibranch pipelines).
env.BUILD_URL	Direct link to this build's page.
env.GIT_COMMIT	SHA of the checked-out commit.

7. CLI & Server Management

Command	What it does
java -jar jenkins.war	Run Jenkins directly (standalone WAR file).
systemctl start jenkins	Start Jenkins service (Linux).
systemctl status jenkins	Check Jenkins service status.
systemctl restart jenkins	Restart the Jenkins service.
cat /var/lib/jenkins/secrets/initialAdminPassword	Get the first-time setup unlock key.
java -jar jenkins-cli.jar -s http://host:8080/ build JOB	Trigger a build via CLI.
java -jar jenkins-cli.jar -s http://host:8080/ list-jobs	List all jobs via CLI.

8. Triggers Quick Reference

Command	What it does
pollSCM('H/5 * * * *')	Check Git for changes every 5 minutes.
cron('H 2 * * *')	Run the build daily around 2 AM.

<code>upstream(upstreamProjects: 'jobA', threshold: hudson.model.Result.SUCCESS)</code>	Trigger after another job succeeds.
GitHub webhook	Instantly trigger build on git push (needs 'GitHub hook trigger' enabled).

Keep this handy while working — bookmark the commands you use most often!